



SPECIFIC ENDURANCE · PRACTICAL GUIDE

+20 Endurance Workouts to Last the Full 90 Minutes

A bank of aerobic, intermittent and ball-based endurance routines, to reach minute 90 fully fit without losing intensity or clarity of decision-making.

Aerobic base

Intermittent high intensity

Endurance with the ball

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The two energy systems of a match

Football is not a single-speed sport: it combines short explosive efforts with an aerobic base that sustains the whole match. Training only one of the two leaves gaps in your performance.



Aerobic system

It's the base: it lets you recover between intense efforts and sustain jogging, walking and positioning throughout the 90 minutes.



Anaerobic system

It's the one you use in every sprint, jump or start: short, very intense efforts repeated dozens of times per match.

150-250

HIGH-INTENSITY ACTIONS PER MATCH
ON AVERAGE

10-13 km

COVERED BY AN OUTFIELD PLAYER IN A
FULL MATCH

2 systems

TO BE TRAINED TOGETHER, NOT
SEPARATELY



KEY TIP

A player with a good aerobic base recovers faster between sprints: that's why, even though football is an explosive sport, base endurance remains a non-negotiable pillar.



Why the final stretch of the match is the most demanding

Most goals are decided after minute 75. It's no coincidence: that's when accumulated fatigue starts to affect technique, decision-making and reaction speed.

- The distance covered at high intensity drops noticeably in the final stretch of the match.
- Technical precision (passes, control, shots) degrades with accumulated fatigue.
- The risk of muscle injury increases in the last 15-20 minutes.
- The ability to make good decisions under pressure also depends on physical condition.



WARNING

Training endurance isn't just "running more": it's training your body and your head to keep making good decisions when you're tired, which is exactly what happens in the final minutes of a real match.



How to use this routine bank

This bank combines four types of endurance. None replaces the other: they complement each other throughout the week.

BLOCK	SUGGESTED WEEKLY FREQUENCY
Aerobic base	1-2 times per week, far from match day
Intermittent high intensity	1-2 times per week
Endurance with the ball	Ideal to integrate into group training
Match simulation	1 time per week, in the specific preseason phase

**KEY TIP**

If you have little time, always prioritize endurance with the ball and intermittent high intensity: they most resemble the real demands of a match.



BLOCK 1 OF 4

Aerobic base

Five general endurance routines, the engine that sustains all the activity of a match.

5 routines · 20-35 minutes each

Intensity: low-moderate

1-2 times per week



Aerobic base

Build the aerobic base that sustains all the activity of the match.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Resistance cycling	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Long runs: 1000 m at a steady pace	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Continuous aerobic circuit (no pauses)	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Brisk uphill walking	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause

**COACH'S TIP**

The right intensity for this block is "conversational": you should be able to talk while doing it.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Aerobic base

Improve the ability to recover between high-intensity efforts.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Long runs: 1000 m at a steady pace	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Endurance swimming (pool)	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Brisk uphill walking	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Machine rowing endurance	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause

**COACH'S TIP**

Progress volume (time or distance) before speed in this type of work.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Aerobic base

Train at low-moderate, conversational intensity, without reaching fatigue.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Easy fartlek with pace changes	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Long runs: 1000 m at a steady pace	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Endurance swimming (pool)	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Machine rowing endurance	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause

**COACH'S TIP**

Alternating surfaces (pool, bike) reduces the accumulated impact on your legs compared to always running.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Aerobic base

Add volume progressively over the weeks.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Long runs: 1000 m at a steady pace	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Jog on gentle hills, controlled pace	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Brisk uphill walking	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Machine rowing endurance	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause



COACH'S TIP

This block works best far from match day, to avoid accumulating unnecessary fatigue.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Aerobic base

Use this block as a complement to, not a substitute for, ball work.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Continuous run at moderate pace	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Endurance swimming (pool)	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Brisk uphill walking	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause
	Machine rowing endurance	1	20-35 min	Steady pace, no pause

**COACH'S TIP**

A good aerobic base is what lets you recover faster between sprints during the match.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



BLOCK 2 OF 4

Intermittent high-intensity endurance

Five routines of repeated efforts with incomplete recovery, the metabolic demand closest to an intense match.

5 routines · 15-20 minutes each

Intensity: high

1-2 times per week



Intermittent high-intensity endurance

Train the ability to repeat intense efforts with incomplete recovery, as in a real match.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	300 m repeats at high pace, short recovery	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	Interval cycling (short, intense blocks)	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	High-intensity burpee blocks	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	Interval jump rope	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest



COACH'S TIP

Effort quality must stay high in every block: if it drops a lot, extend the rest.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Intermittent high-intensity endurance

Raise the ceiling of intensity you can sustain repeatedly.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	300 m repeats at high pace, short recovery	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	Metabolic circuit with medicine ball	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	High-intensity burpee blocks	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	Interval jump rope	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest



COACH'S TIP

This type of training is demanding on the nervous system: 1-2 times per week is enough.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Intermittent high-intensity endurance

Bring the training stimulus closer to the real demand of a high-intensity match.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	300 m repeats at high pace, short recovery	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	Metabolic circuit with medicine ball	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	High-intensity burpee blocks	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	Short sprint + recovery jog, repeated	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest



COACH'S TIP

Record your heart rate if you can: it gives you objective information about your progress.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Intermittent high-intensity endurance

Improve fatigue tolerance without losing movement technique.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Metabolic circuit with medicine ball	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	Interval cycling (short, intense blocks)	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	Continuous mountain climbers in blocks	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	Short sprint + recovery jog, repeated	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest



COACH'S TIP

You don't need to do all four stations at maximum effort from day one: progress the intensity.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Intermittent high-intensity endurance

Combine full-body exercises for a complete metabolic stimulus.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	300 m repeats at high pace, short recovery	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	Interval shuttle run	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	Interval cycling (short, intense blocks)	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest
	Continuous mountain climbers in blocks	4-5	30-45 sec effort	30-45 sec rest



COACH'S TIP

This block is the one that most resembles, in metabolic demand, the last 20 minutes of a match.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



BLOCK 3 OF 4

Endurance with the ball

Five routines that combine physical demand with real technical-tactical demand.

5 routines · 15-25 minutes each

Ideal in group training

Priority: passing quality under fatigue



Endurance with the ball

Train endurance without disconnecting it from the real technical and tactical demand.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Technical-physical circuit with ball	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	Passing circuit under accumulated fatigue	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	Possession with immediate pressing after losing the ball	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	Dribbling and finishing under fatigue	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min



COACH'S TIP

This block is ideal to integrate into team training, not just as individual work.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Endurance with the ball

Sustain passing and control quality even with a fatigued body.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Intense rondo in a small space	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	4 vs 2 possession at high tempo	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	Continuous pass and move (large rondo)	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	Passing circuit under accumulated fatigue	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min



COACH'S TIP

When passing quality drops noticeably, it's time to lower the intensity or cut the block.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Endurance with the ball

Bring the physical stimulus closer to the logic of the game, not just to running without the ball.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Intense rondo in a small space	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	Continuous pass and move (large rondo)	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	4v4 small-sided game with quick transitions	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	Passing circuit under accumulated fatigue	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min



COACH'S TIP

The intense rondo in a small space is among the exercises with the best physical-to-technical demand ratio.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Endurance with the ball

Improve decision-making under time pressure and opponent pressure.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Intense rondo in a small space	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	4 vs 2 possession at high tempo	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	Continuous pass and move (large rondo)	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	Dribbling and finishing under fatigue	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min



COACH'S TIP

Change the number of players and the size of the space to vary the physical demand of the exercise.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Endurance with the ball

Take advantage of group training to work on endurance without it feeling like "just physical" work.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Continuous pass and move (large rondo)	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	4v4 small-sided game with quick transitions	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	Passing circuit under accumulated fatigue	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min
	Possession with immediate pressing after losing the ball	3-4	3-5 min	1-2 min



COACH'S TIP

Add limited-touch rules to raise the decision-making demand under fatigue.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



BLOCK 4 OF 4

Match simulation

Five blocks that reproduce the real physical demand of the 90 minutes, including the wear of the second half.

5 routines · 25-40 minutes each

1 time per week in the specific phase

Ideal in preseason



Match simulation

Reproduce the real demand of the 90 minutes in training.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Match-style repeated-effort circuit	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Second-half simulation: accumulated fatigue + technique	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Alternating sprint and possession blocks	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Final circuit: technique under maximum fatigue	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min



COACH'S TIP

This block makes the most sense in preseason or in planned high-load weeks.

LOG (DATE • LOAD/INTENSITY • RPE 1-10 • NOTES)



Match simulation

Assess how your technique and decision-making hold up under real accumulated fatigue.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	6v6 small-sided game on real pitch dimensions	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Second-half simulation: accumulated fatigue + technique	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Intermittent endurance test (progressive)	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Final circuit: technique under maximum fatigue	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min



COACH'S TIP

It isn't necessary to do it every week: 1 time per week at the right moment is enough.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Match simulation

Prepare specifically for the second half, where most injuries and goals against occur.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	15-minute blocks at match intensity	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Second-half simulation: accumulated fatigue + technique	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Intermittent endurance test (progressive)	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Match with high-intensity rules (limited touches)	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min



COACH'S TIP

Pay attention to how your technique feels in the last minutes of each block: that's where the most valuable information is.

LOG (DATE • LOAD/INTENSITY • RPE 1-10 • NOTES)



Match simulation

Close the endurance cycle with the most match-specific stimulus possible.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Match-style repeated-effort circuit	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Match with high-intensity rules (limited touches)	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Alternating sprint and possession blocks	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Final circuit: technique under maximum fatigue	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min



COACH'S TIP

Combine it with good recovery work afterwards (see the post-match recovery ebook).

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Match simulation

Build physical confidence for the last 20 minutes of competition.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	15-minute blocks at match intensity	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Match-style repeated-effort circuit	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Intermittent endurance test (progressive)	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min
	Match with high-intensity rules (limited touches)	1-2	10-15 min	2-3 min



COACH'S TIP

Also use it as a thermometer: if it feels much harder than in previous weeks, check your rest.

LOG (DATE • LOAD/INTENSITY • RPE 1-10 • NOTES)

TO CLOSE

Reach minute 90 fully fit

Endurance isn't just about holding on: it's about still being the same technical and tactical player at minute 85 as at minute 5. These 20 routines build that capacity progressively and specifically for football.



Keep 1-2 aerobic base sessions per week, far from match day.



Add intermittent high intensity to get closer to the real demands of the game.



Prioritize endurance with the ball whenever you can: it trains physical condition and technique together.



Reserve match simulation for planned high-load periods.



Combine this plan with good recovery between sessions.



This material is for educational and general training purposes. It does not replace the planning of a fitness coach or the evaluation of a health professional in case of symptoms of overtraining or injury.